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MySQL AUTO INCREMENT Field

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MySQL AUTO INCREMENT Field

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An auto-increment field is a numeric column that automatically generates a unique number, when a new record is inserted into a table.

The auto-increment field is typically the `PRIMARY KEY` field that we want to automatically be assigned a unique number, every time a new record is inserted.

MySQL AUTO_INCREMENT Keyword

MySQL uses the `AUTO_INCREMENT` keyword to perform an auto-increment feature.

The following SQL defines the "Personid" column to be an auto-increment primary key field in the "Persons" table:

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```
    LastName varchar(255) NOT NULL,
    FirstName varchar(255),
    Age int
);
```

The default starting value for `AUTO_INCREMENT` is 1, and it will increment by 1 for each new record.

To let `AUTO_INCREMENT` start with another value, use the following SQL statement:

```
ALTER TABLE Persons AUTO_INCREMENT = 100;
```

When we insert a new record into the "Persons" table, we will NOT have to specify a value for the "Personid" column (a unique value will be added automatically):

```
INSERT INTO Persons (FirstName, LastName)
VALUES ('Lars', 'Monsen');
```

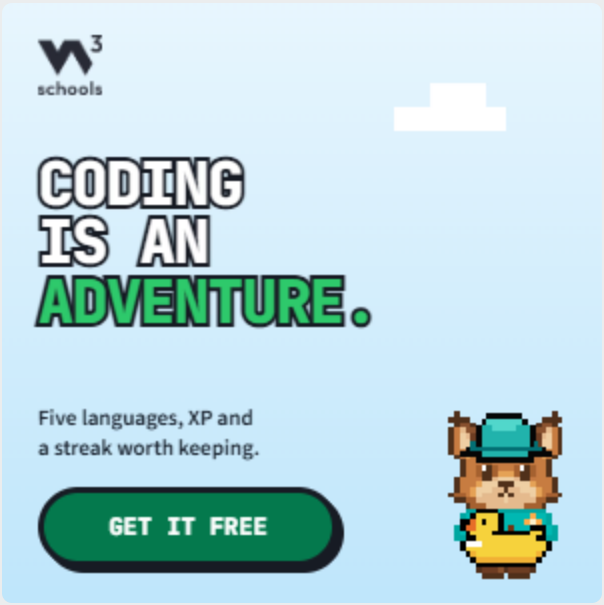
The SQL above inserts a new record into the "Persons" table, and the "Personid" column will automatically be assigned the next unique number.

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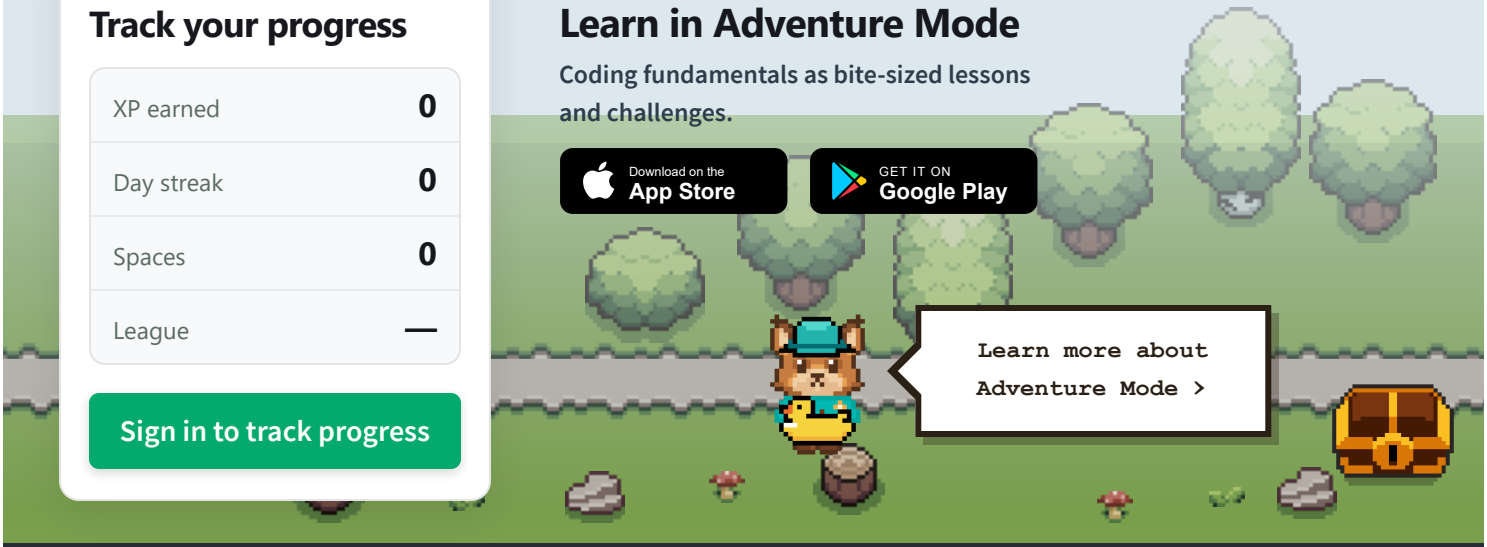
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